

October, 2023

HELPERS DIGEST

EDUCATION - HEALTH - GOVERNANCE - GENDER - SOCIAL ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT - AGRICULTURE

RESILIENCE AND RENEWAL: YA GABTU SHATTIMA'S JOURNEY

Meet Ya Gabtu Shattima, a 50-year-old woman who has been married for years, with five children and three beloved grandchildren under her care. Her entrepreneurial journey began with the production of oil and groundnut cakes (kuli-kuli), which thrived initially. However, her world took a dramatic turn when insurgency struck, and her husband lost his shop in the market. Suddenly, she found herself shouldering the family's financial burden with the



Within five months, Ya Gabtu's profits reached an impressive N25,000.

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FROM
STRUGGLE
TO SUCCESS

Meet Falmata Bulama, a 40-year-old woman residing in Gongulong community, Jere LGA, Maiduguri, Borno State. Eight years ago, she lost her husband, leaving her to navigate life's challenges with their ten vulnerable children. Falmata had been running a snack (chin-chin) business for a decade, but the rising cost of ingredients had made it unprofitable.

With her determination to provide for her family and keep her business alive, Falmata faced numerous obstacles. However, her life took a positive turn thanks to the intervention of ZOA in partnership with Life Helpers Initiative (LHI). They introduced the Group Savings and Loan Association (GSLA), and Falmata seized the opportunity to join. After just three savings cycles, she became one of the selected beneficiaries to receive essential items for meat

pie and doughnut production.

This support allowed Falmata to embark on a new business venture. She purchased five measures of flour and, through her efforts, earned a profit of N3000. Falmata's life has significantly improved. She can now provide for her children,



...through her efforts,
earned a profit of N3000.

Success is never so
interesting as struggle.

meager resources from her business.

Facing dwindling capital and grandchildren who had to give up their education due to financial constraints, Ya Gabtu's situation was dire. That's when ZOA, in partnership with Life Helpers Initiative (LHI), introduced the Group Savings and Loan Association (GSLA) as part of their intervention to uplift livelihoods. Ya Gabtu seized this opportunity and joined the GSLA group. After just three savings cycles, ZOA/LHI provided her with essential business tools, including 16 plates of groundnuts, a pot, a frying pan, and firewood. With renewed vigor, she restarted her business.

Within five months, Ya Gabtu's profits reached an impressive N5,000. She has diversified her income streams by selling a bag of rice weekly, yielding a profit of N4,500 per week. Furthermore, she expanded her business by selling fresh tomatoes from the farm during harvest season.

For Ya Gabtu Shattima, life has become significantly easier. She can now provide for her children and grandchildren, ensuring they receive an education. Her business is thriving, and she's found joy in her work, as LHI team witnessed during their visit to her bustling sales point.



Chinwendu's **Nutrition Triumph** in Ebonyi State

Lack of nutrition awareness and growth monitoring plagued Chinwendu's family in Ebonyi State. Her struggles at 11 months old were compounded by weight issues and persistent illnesses, despite feeding efforts.

Through the IHP Nutrition project, we stepped in. Guiding her mother with nutritional counseling and introducing nutrient-rich Tom Brown brought positive change. Even financial hurdles couldn't deter progress.

With diligence, we saw transformation: by July 25, 2023, Chinwendu's weight increased to 6kg, height to 60cm, and MUAC to 11cm. Beyond numbers, her family's mindset shifted - their commitment even led them to an RUTF outreach. Chinwendu's story is a beacon of the power of education and compassionate intervention, sparking growth and change in Ebonyi State.



BEFORE PICTURE



Full Name:
Nwigwe
Chinwendu

Age: 11months
Sex: female
Weight: 5.6kg
Height: 56cm
MUAC: 10.3cm
Date: 20/06/23

AFTER PICTURE



Full Name:
Nwigwe
Chinwendu

Age: 12months
Sex: female
Weight: 6kg
Height: 60cm
MUAC: 11cm
Date: 25/07/23



Transforming Lives Through Nutrition: Rejoice's Inspiring Journey

Meet Joseph Rejoice, a vibrant young child from Onicha local government area in Ebonyi. Rejoice's path to health and well-being was significantly impacted by an extraordinary initiative organized by Life Helpers Initiative (LHI) in partnership with the IHP Nutrition project.

Upon her arrival at the Onicha health facility, Rejoice was assessed to be severely malnourished. Her anthropometric measurements revealed an **MUAC of just 11.2 cm, a weight of 8.6 kg, a height of 70 cm, and an age of 16 months**. It was evident that her health was in a precarious state, and her mother voiced concerns about her feeding challenges, primarily due to financial constraints.

Rejoice's mother received personalized guidance on nutrition, with a focus on creating five-star meals using locally available and affordable foods. She was encouraged to introduce fortified pap, nourishing potato porridge, and incorporate essential animal sources, fruits, and vegetables into Rejoice's diet. The importance of a diet rich in vegetables, fruits, and animal sources, including cooked eggs, was emphasized. Additionally, the concept of a home garden was

introduced, offering faster access to nutritious vegetables.

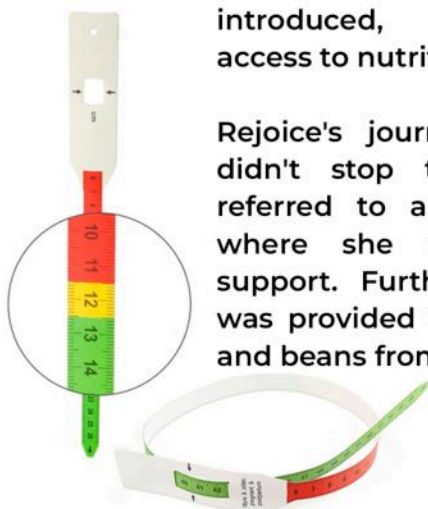
Rejoice's journey to recovery didn't stop there. She was referred to an IMAM Center, where she received crucial support. Furthermore, Rejoice was provided with Tom Brown and beans from the Food Bank,



ensuring a consistent supply of nutritious essentials. The commitment of Rejoice's mother was commendable as she actively participated in food demonstration sessions, absorbing valuable knowledge for her child's well-being.

The transformation was nothing short of remarkable. During the third visit, everyone presents, including the mother, health workers, and fellow caregivers, witnessed the astonishing progress in Rejoice's health. She had transitioned from Severe Acute Malnutrition (SAM) to Moderate Acute Malnutrition (MAM), as evidenced by her improved MUAC of 12.4 cm, weight of 8.8 kg, height of 76 cm, and 17 months old.

Rejoice's journey stands as a testament to the power of education, compassion, and dedicated intervention. Her remarkable turnaround from a state of severe malnutrition to one of steady progress and hope showcases the profound impact of initiatives like LHI's and the IHP Nutrition project. Rejoice's story is not just one of transformation; it's a story of resilience, empowerment, and the boundless possibilities that can emerge when communities come together to support the health and well-being of their youngest members.





Tayo Fatinikun
Joy Dauda Dogo
Oluwafemi Tanimowo
Adetola Olabode
Nosa Ojo



LIFE HELPERS INITIATIVE

Putting a smile on a face

OUR MISSION

To be a leading non-governmental organisation, empowering children, youths, women and communities, to live maximally in all aspect of life through advocacy, capacity development initiatives, community mobilization and social economic development.

OUR VISION

A more fulfilled life for every person

OUR VALUES

- Love -** Friendly Atmosphere, Togetherness, Kind Gestures
- HONESTY -** Openness, Forthrightness
- INTERGRITY -** Equity, Matching our words with our Actions; Acceptance; Access; Opportunity for staffs and clients.



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